serviceOrchestration MQTT/TLS/JSON

Interface Design Description

Service ID: *"serviceOrchestration"*

Abstract
This document describes the MQTT protocol with TLS payload security and JSON payload encoding variant of the `serviceOrchestration` service of the DynamicServiceOrchestration system.

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1 Overview

This document describes the `serviceOrchestration` service interface of the DynamicServiceOrchestration system over MQTT, which provides service orchestration: a consumer asks which provider it should use for a service, and receives the matching, authorized providers with the interfaces to call.

It's implemented using protocol, encoding as stated in below table:

Profile type	Type	Version
Transfer protocol	MQTT	3.1.1 [1]
Data encryption	TLS	1.3 [2], 1.2 [3]
Encoding	JSON	RFC 8259 [4]
Compression	N/A	-
Semantics	N/A	-
Ontology	N/A	-

Table 1: Communication and semantics details used for the `serviceOrchestration` service interface

This document provides the Interface Design Description IDD to the *serviceOrchestration – Service Description* document [5]. The operations, their semantics and the data models are the same as in the HTTP/TLS/JSON IDD [6]; this document specifies the MQTT binding.

The MQTT interface is offered only when the system runs with `mqtt.api.enabled=true`; it is then registered with the interface template `generic_mqtts` (`generic_mqtt` without TLS), the broker address and port (`mqtt.broker.address`, `mqtt.broker.port`) and the base topic `arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/`. In the Arrowhead-test-cloud-java deployment the MQTT interfaces of the core systems are disabled.

2 Service Operations

The provider subscribes to one topic per operation, the base topic followed by the operation name:

Operation	Request topic
`pull`	`arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/pull`
`subscribe`	`arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/subscribe`
`unsubscribe`	`arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/unsubscribe`

A consumer publishes a request envelope (MqttRequestTemplate) to the topic and receives the answer (MqttResponseTemplate) on its own `responseTopic`. The `authentication` field carries the requester's identity according to the provider's authentication policy: `IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>` (outsourced or internal policy), `SYSTEM//<name>` (declared policy) or the requester's X.509 certificate (certificate policy). The `status` of the response uses the HTTP status code numbers (200, 201, 204, 400, 401, 403, 404, 408, 423, 500, 503); on error the payload is an ErrorMessage.

```
{
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "authentication": "IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>",
  "responseTopic": "arrowhead/response/TemperatureDisplay/a1b2c3",
  "qosRequirement": 1,
  "params": {},
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 1: Request envelope.

```
{
  "status": 200,
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "receiver": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 2: Response envelope.

2.1 PUBLISH `arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/pull`

Operation: pull
Input: OrchestrationRequest
Output: OrchestrationResponse

Executes a dynamic orchestration for the requester: service discovery in the ServiceRegistry, removal of locked, blacklisted and unauthorized candidates, interface matching (optionally with translation), preferences, QoS evaluation, matchmaking, exclusive reservation and token generation. Without local results and with `ALLOW_INTERCLOUD`, or directly with `ONLY_INTERCLOUD`, the Gatekeeper is asked (local extension).

```
{
  "serviceRequirement": {
    "serviceDefinition": "temperatureReading",
    "operations": [
      "FILTER"
    ],
    "versions": [
      "1.0.0"
    ],
    "alivesAt": "2026-10-22T12:00:00Z",
```

```
    "metadataRequirements": [
      {
        "unit": "celsius"
      }
    ],
    "interfaceTemplateNames": [
      "string"
    ],
    "interfaceAddressTypes": [
      "string"
    ],
    "interfacePropertyRequirements": [
      {
        "unit": "celsius"
      }
    ],
    "securityPolicies": [
      "string"
    ],
    "preferredProviders": [
      "string"
    ]
  },
  "orchestrationFlags": {
    "MATCHMAKING": true
  },
  "qualityRequirements": [
    {
      "type": "PING",
      "operation": "FILTER",
      "requirements": {
        "maxLatency": 100
      }
    }
  ],
  "exclusivityDuration": 60
}
```

Listing 3: Payload of an pull request.

2.2 PUBLISH `arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/subscribe`

Operation: subscribe
Input: OrchestrationSubscriptionRequest
Output: String

Creates (or replaces) a push subscription of the requester for itself; with `trigger=true` the orchestration is executed and pushed immediately. Returns the subscription identifier, 201 for a new subscription.

Optional entries of `params`: `trigger`.

```
{
  "targetSystemName": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "orchestrationRequest": {
    "serviceRequirement": {
      "serviceDefinition": "temperatureReading",
      "operations": [
        "FILTER"
      ],
      "versions": [
        "1.0.0"
      ],
      "alivesAt": "2026-10-22T12:00:00Z",
      "metadataRequirements": [
        {
          "unit": "celsius"
        }
```

```
      ],
      "interfaceTemplateNames": [
        "string"
      ],
      "interfaceAddressTypes": [
        "string"
      ],
      "interfacePropertyRequirements": [
        {
          "unit": "celsius"
        }
      ],
      "securityPolicies": [
        "string"
      ],
      "preferredProviders": [
        "string"
      ]
    },
    "orchestrationFlags": {
      "MATCHMAKING": true
    },
    "qualityRequirements": [
      {
        "type": "PING",
        "operation": "FILTER",
        "requirements": {
          "maxLatency": 100
        }
      }
    ],
    "exclusivityDuration": 60
  },
  "notifyInterface": {
    "protocol": "HTTPS",
    "properties": {
      "address": "192.168.0.20",
      "port": "8080",
      "method": "POST",
      "path": "/orchestration/notify"
    }
  },
  "duration": 3600
}
```

Listing 4: Payload of an subscribe request.

2.3 PUBLISH arrowhead/serviceorchestration/orchestration/unsubscribe

Operation: unsubscribe
Input: String

Removes a subscription of the requester. Returns 200 if removed, 204 if it did not exist.

```
"3fa85f64-5717-4562-b3fc-2c963f66afa6"
```

Listing 5: Payload of an unsubscribe request.

3 Data Models

Here, all data objects that can be part of the service calls associated with this service are listed in alphabetic order. Each *struct* denotes a JSON Object with the named fields; fields that are not needed may be omitted.

3.1 struct MqttRequestTemplate

The request envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"traceId"	String	Identifier chosen by the requester, returned in the response.
"authentication"	String	Identity of the requester (see Section 2).
"responseTopic"	String	Topic on which the response is published.
"qosRequirement"	Number	MQTT QoS of the response (0, 1 or 2).
"params"	Object<String>	Optional parameters (the query parameters of the HTTP binding).
"payload"	Object	The operation input.

3.2 struct MqttResponseTemplate

The response envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"status"	Number	Status code.
"traceId"	String	The trace identifier of the request.
"receiver"	String	Name of the requester.
"payload"	Object	The operation output, or an ErrorMessage.

3.3 struct ErrorMessage

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"errorMessage"	String	
"errorCode"	Number	
"exceptionType"	ExceptionType	
"origin"	String	

3.4 struct AuthorizationTokenGenerationResponse

A generated token.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"tokenType"	AuthorizationTokenType	Token type: `TIME_LIMITED_TOKEN`, `USAGE_LIMITED_TOKEN`, `SELF_CONTAINED_TOKEN` or `TRANSLATION_BRIDGE_TOKEN`.
"targetType"	AuthorizationTargetType	Target type: `SERVICE_DEF` or `EVENT_TYPE`.
"token"	String	The token (opaque string, Base64 or JSON Web Token).
"usageLimit"	Number	Number of allowed uses (usage-limited tokens).
"expiresAt"	DateTime	UTC expiry of time-limited tokens.

3.5 struct MetadataRequirement

A JSON object of metadata requirements: each key is a metadata path (dot notation), each value the required value or an operator object such as `{"op": "LESS_THAN", "value": 10}`.

3.6 struct OrchestrationNotifyInterface

Notification endpoint of push orchestration.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"protocol"	String	Protocol of the notification: `HTTP`, `HTTPS`, `MQTT` or `MQTTS`.
"properties"	Object<String>	For HTTP(S) `address`, `port`, `method`, `path`; for MQTT(S) `topic` (and broker `address`, `port`).

3.7 struct OrchestrationRequest

An orchestration request.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"serviceRequirement"	OrchestrationServiceRequirement	Requirements on the service the consumer wants to use.
"orchestrationFlags"	Object<Boolean>	Orchestration flags, e.g. `MATCHMAKING`, `ONLY_PREFERRED`, `ALLOW_INTERCLOUD`.
"qualityRequirements"	Array<QoSRequirement>	Quality-of-service requirements (evaluated by DeviceQoSEvaluator).
"exclusivityDuration"	Number	Requested exclusive reservation of the provider in seconds.

3.8 struct OrchestrationResponse

The orchestration result.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"results"	Array<OrchestrationResult>	The orchestration results, best first.
"warnings"	Array<String>	Warnings of the orchestration, e.g. `autoMatchmaking`, `notExclusive`, `interCloud`.

3.9 struct OrchestrationResult

One provider of the requested service.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"serviceInstanceId"	String	Service instance identifier `<System>|<serviceDefinition>|<version>`.
"cloudIdentitifer"	String	Cloud identifier of the provider (`LOCAL` for the own cloud). The JSON name keeps the upstream spelling.
"providerName"	String	Name of the provider system.
"serviceDefinitition"	String	Service definition name. The JSON name keeps the upstream spelling.
"version"	Version	Version of the service instance.
"aliveUntil"	String	Time until which the service instance is registered (its expiry), if any.
"exclusiveUntil"	String	Time until which the instance is reserved exclusively for the consumer, if reserved.
"metadata"	Object	Metadata of the service instance.
"interfaces"	Array<ServiceInstanceInterface Response>	Interfaces the consumer can use (only matching ones).
"authorizationTokens"	Object<Object<AuthorizationToken GenerationResponse>>	Authorization tokens generated for the consumer, per interface template and operation.

3.10 struct OrchestrationServiceRequirement

Requirements on the requested service.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"serviceDefinition"	String	Service definition name.
"operations"	Array<String>	Service operations the consumer wants to use.
"versions"	Array<Version>	Accepted service versions.
"alivesAt"	DateTime	Only instances that are still registered (not expired) at this UTC time are matched.
"metadata Requirements"	Array<MetadataRequirement>	Requirements on the service instance metadata; each map is one alternative.
"interfaceTemplate Names"	Array<String>	Accepted interface templates, e.g. `generic_https`.
"interfaceAddressTypes"	Array<String>	Address types the provider interface must offer.
"interfaceProperty Requirements"	Array<MetadataRequirement>	Requirements on the interface properties; each map is one alternative.
"securityPolicies"	Array<String>	Accepted interface security policies.
"preferredProviders"	Array<String>	Provider systems to prefer.

3.11 struct OrchestrationSubscriptionRequest

A push orchestration subscription.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"targetSystemName"	String	Consumer system; default the requester.
"orchestrationRequest"	OrchestrationRequest	The orchestration request executed for the subscription.
"notifyInterface"	OrchestrationNotifyInterface	Where and how the orchestration result is pushed to the target system.
"duration"	Number	Requested lifetime of the subscription in seconds; no value means unlimited.

3.12 struct QoSRequirement

One quality-of-service requirement.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"type"	String	Type of the QoS evaluation, as known by DeviceQoSEvaluator.
"operation"	String	QoS operation: `FILTER` or `SORT`.
"requirements"	Object	Parameters of the QoS requirement.

3.13 struct ServiceInstanceInterfaceResponse

One interface of a service instance.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"templateName"	String	Name of the interface template, snake_case (e.g. `generic_https`).
"protocol"	String	Protocol of the interface, e.g. `http`, `https`, `mqtt`, `mqtts`.
"policy"	String	Security policy of the interface: `NONE`, `CERT_AUTH` or one of the token policies.
"properties"	Object	Interface properties defined by the template, e.g. `accessAddresses`, `accessPort`, `basePath`, `operations`.

3.14 Primitives

As all messages are encoded using the JSON format [4], the following primitive constructs, part of that standard, become available.

Type	Description
Array	A JSON Array [4]; Array<A> has elements of type A.
AuthorizationTargetType	One of `SERVICE_DEF`, `EVENT_TYPE` (JSON String).
AuthorizationTokenType	One of `TIME_LIMITED_TOKEN`, `USAGE_LIMITED_TOKEN`, `SELF_CONTAINED_TOKEN`, `TRANSLATION_BRIDGE_TOKEN` (JSON String).
Boolean	JSON Boolean, `true` or `false`.
DateTime	JSON String with an ISO 8601 UTC timestamp, e.g. `2026-10-22T12:00:00Z`.
ExceptionType	One of `ARROWHEAD`, `INVALID_PARAMETER`, `AUTH`, `FORBIDDEN`, `DATA_NOT_FOUND`, `TIMEOUT`, `LOCKED`, `INTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR`, `EXTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR` (JSON String).
Number	JSON Number, an integer.
Object	JSON Object; Object<A> has string keys and values of type A.
String	JSON String.
Version	JSON String, semantic version `major.minor.patch`.

4 References

[1] A. Banks and R. Gupta, “Mqtt version 3.1.1,” OASIS, Standard, 2014.

[2] E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.3,” IETF, RFC 8446, 2018.

[3] T. Dierks and E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.2,” IETF, RFC 5246, 2008.

[4] T. Bray, “The javascript object notation (json) data interchange format,” IETF, RFC 8259, 2017.

[5] J. Delsing, “serviceOrchestration – Service Description (DynamicServiceOrchestration),” Eclipse Arrowhead, SD 5.2.2, 2026, dynamicServiceOrchestration-v5.2.2-serviceOrchestration-SD.pdf.

[6] ——, “serviceOrchestration HTTP/TLS/JSON – Interface Design Description (DynamicServiceOrchestration),” Eclipse Arrowhead, IDD 5.2.2, 2026, dynamicServiceOrchestration-v5.2.2-serviceOrchestration-HTTP-IDD.pdf.

5 Revision History

5.1 Amendments

No.	Date	Version	Subject of Amendments	Author
1	2026-10-22	5.2.2	Document created from the Arrowhead LaTeX templates for the 5.2.2 Java Spring implementation, including the local extensions of this workspace.	Jerker Delsing

5.2 Quality Assurance

No.	Date	Version	Approved by
1		5.2.2	